

Core Concept

RULE: Use ■■■■■ (haadha) for THIS with masculine nouns. Use ■■■■■ (haadhihi) for THIS with feminine nouns.

Key Rule — Gender

Every Arabic noun has gender — masculine or feminine. Most feminine nouns end in ■ (ta marbuta). Always match the demonstrative to the noun's gender.

Demonstrative	Gender	Example	Meaning
■■■■■ (haadha)	Masculine	■■■■■ ■■■■■■	This is a book
■■■■■ (haadhihi)	Feminine	■■■■■ ■■■■■■■■	This is a school

Tanween ■ — Indefinite Nouns

RULE: The double-damma ■ at the end of a noun means 'a ____' (indefinite). Pronounced 'un': baytUN = a house.

10 Masculine Nouns to Memorise

Arabic	Transliteration	Meaning
■■■■■	baytun	a house
■■■■■■■	masjidun	a mosque
■■■■■■■	kitaabun	a book
■■■■■	qalamun	a pen
■■■■■	baabun	a door
■■■■■■■■■	miftaahun	a key
■■■■■■■■■	kursiyyun	a chair
■■■■■	rajulun	a man
■■■■■	waladun	a boy
■■■■■■■	taalibun	a student (m)

10 Feminine Nouns to Memorise

Arabic	Transliteration	Meaning
■■■■■■■■■	madrasatun	a school
■■■■■■■	ghurfatun	a room
■■■■■■■■■	sayyaaratun	a car
■■■■■■■	shajaratun	a tree
■■■■■■■■■	haqeebatun	a bag
■■■■■■■■■	taawilatun	a table

■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	imraatun	a woman
■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	bintun	a girl (exception: no ■)
■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	hirratun	a cat
■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	taalibatun	a student (f)

Questions

Question	Arabic	Meaning
What is this? (m)	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Maa haadha?
What is this? (f)	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Maa haadhihi?
Who is this? (m)	■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Man haadha?

Key Points

- ★ No verb needed in Arabic: ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ = This is a house (no 'is' word!)
- ★ ■ at the end = feminine → use ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■
- ★ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ (girl) has no ■ but is still feminine — naturally female nouns are feminine
- ★ ■ ■ ■ ■ makes it definite: ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ = a house → ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ = THE house (tanween disappears)